7.3.1 Cedar’s representation of PARC

To evaluate a policy, Cedar needs input. That input is an access request following the PARC model: Principal, Action, Resource, and Context. These elements are provided to the Cedar engine as structured data—usually JSON—and evaluated against the policies in a policy store. The following JSON shows an example of such a request asking whether Bob can edit a document from a managed device:

```
{
  "principal": "Employee::\"bob\"",
  "action": "Action::\"edit\"",
  "resource": "Document::\"doc456\"",
  "context": {
    "device": {
      "is_managed": true
    },
    "time": "2025-07-08T10:30:00Z"
  }
}
```

This JSON offers a structured input to the policy engine, representing a principal, action, resource, and context.